

HP's waste woes

The Himachal Pradesh government's **proposed Policy** for Solid Waste Management Facilities in Rural Areas, 2024, though a welcome move, **raises pressing** concerns about the state's overall waste management strategy. Aiming to **streamline** waste **segregation** and **disposal** at the panchayat level, the policy must be **expedited** as HP is already **grappling with** a waste crisis, **exacerbated** by ineffective **execution** of past plans. The data is **staggering**. The state generates approximately 375 tonnes of solid waste daily across 60 urban local bodies (ULBs). The **legacy** waste **backlog** stands at over 2.48 lakh tonnes, with only six of the 16 identified sites having been cleared. **Meanwhile**, the National Green Tribunal has **flagged** a 9.6-MLD (million litres per day) shortfall in sewage treatment capacity and 20 ULBs still lack sewage management facilities. Shockingly, while some sewage treatment plants are overloaded, a significant proportion of households remain disconnected, exposing a critical **flaw** in planning.

The government has signed **pacts** with cement manufacturers for co-processing non-recyclable plastic waste, but this remains a limited solution. A large **proportion** of plastic waste —from shampoo bottles to chips packets — **continues** to **clog** water bodies and urban **landscapes**. While over four lakh rural households still await access to proper wet waste disposal, the **sheer volume** of **accumulating** garbage **suggests** that **incremental** measures will not **suffice**.



A long-term, action-oriented strategy is needed — one that includes mandatory waste segregation at source, expansion of waste-to-energy projects, stricter plastic production regulations and **comprehensive** recycling initiatives. The recently announced environmental cell within the Urban Development Department must act **decisively** to **bridge** policy **gaps**. Himachal's **fragile ecology** cannot **withstand** poor waste management. The voters must make it a poll issue, **pressing upon** the government to **embrace** outcome-driven **enforcement**. Otherwise, the very **hills** that attract millions of tourists **will** soon be **buried** under **mounting** waste.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

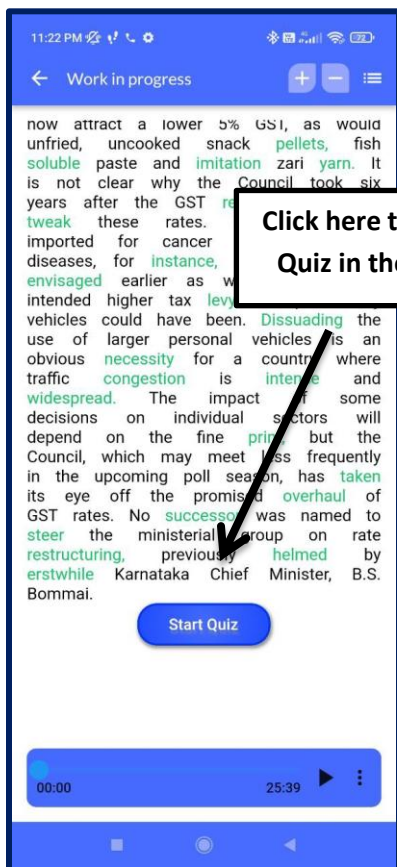
1. **Woes** (noun) – Troubles, Problems, Difficulties, Hardships, Challenges संकट
2. **Proposed** (adjective) – Suggested, Recommended, Planned, Intended, Proposed प्रस्तावित
3. **Pressing** (adjective) – Urgent, Critical, Immediate, Acute, Important जरूरी
4. **Streamline** (verb) – Simplify, Organize, Rationalize, Systematize, Optimize सुव्यवस्थित करना
5. **Segregation** (noun) – Separation, Sorting, Division, Classification, Isolation अलगाव
6. **Disposal** (noun) – Disposition, Removal, Discarding, Elimination, Clearance निपटान
7. **Expedite** (verb) – Accelerate, Hasten, Speed up, Facilitate, Quicken तेज करना
8. **Grapple** (with) (verb) – Struggle, Deal, Cope, Tackle, Confront जूझना
9. **Exacerbate** (verb) – Worsen, Aggravate, Intensify, Escalate, Heighten बढ़ाना
10. **Execution** (noun) – Implementation, Performance, Enforcement, Accomplishment, Realization कार्यान्वयन
11. **Staggering** (adjective) – Astonishing, Shocking, Overwhelming, Astounding, Stunning चौंका देने वाला
12. **Legacy** (adjective) – something that is old, outdated, or inherited from the past, विरासत
13. **Backlog** (noun) – Accumulation, Pile-up, Stockpile, Reserve, Heap जमाव
14. **Meanwhile** (adverb) – Simultaneously, Concurrently, In the meantime, At the same time, Meanwhile इसी बीच
15. **Flag** (verb) – Highlight, Indicate, Point out, Mark, Signal चिह्नित करना
16. **Flaw** (noun) – Defect, Weakness, Imperfection, Fault, Shortcoming खामी
17. **Pact** (noun) – Agreement, Treaty, Deal, Contract, Accord समझौता
18. **Clog** (verb) – Block, Obstruct, Jam, Congest, Choke रुकावट डालना
19. **Landscape** (noun) – Terrain, Scenery, Environment, Topography, Vista परिदृश्य
20. **Sheer** (adjective) – Utter, Absolute, Complete, Total, Pure निरा
21. **Accumulate** (verb) – Gather, Collect, Amass, Build up, Stockpile जमा करना
22. **Incremental** (adjective) – Gradual, Step-by-step, Progressive, Phased, Cumulative क्रमिक
23. **Suffice** (verb) – Be enough, Be adequate, Meet needs, Satisfy, Serve पर्याप्त होना

24. **Comprehensive** (adjective) – Thorough, Complete, Exhaustive, Extensive, Inclusive
व्यापक
25. **Decisively** (adverb) – Firmly, Resolutely, Conclusively, Effectively, Authoritatively
निर्णायक रूप से
26. **Bridge gap** (phrase) – Close gap, Fill gap, Narrow gap, Connect, Link अंतर कम करना
27. **Fragile** (adjective) – Delicate, Vulnerable, Weak, Brittle, Sensitive नाजुक
28. **Ecology** (noun) – Environment, Ecosystem, Habitat, Nature, Biodiversity पारिस्थितिकी
29. **Withstand** (verb) – Endure, Resist, Survive, Bear, Tolerate सहन करना
30. **Press upon** (phrasal verb) – Urge, Insist, Emphasize, Stress, Push जोर देना
31. **Embrace** (verb) – Adopt, Accept, Welcome, Support, Take up अपनाना
32. **Enforcement** (noun) – Implementation, Execution, Application, Imposition, Regulation प्रवर्तन
33. **Bury** (verb) – Submerge, Hide, Conceal, Cover, Immerse दफनाना
34. **Mounting** (adjective) – Increasing, Growing, Rising, Escalating, Accumulating बढ़ता हुआ

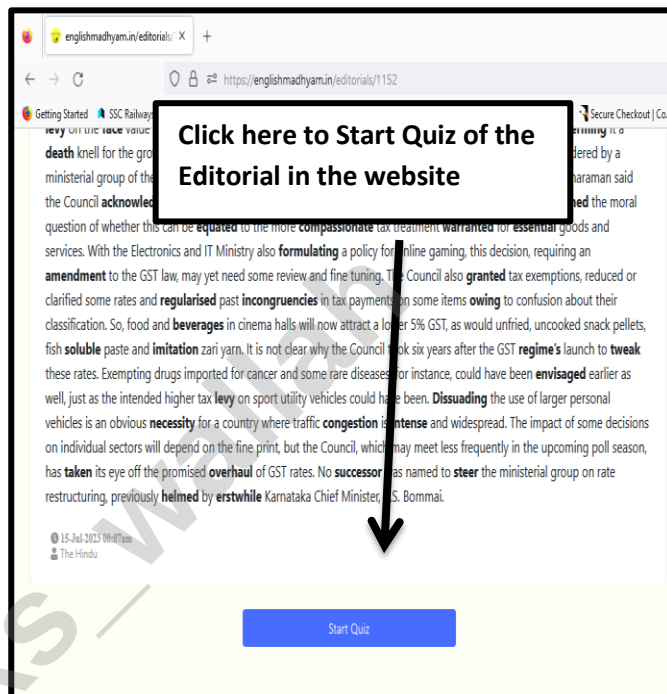
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Proposed Policy:** Himachal Pradesh (HP) has introduced a Policy for Solid Waste Management Facilities in Rural Areas, 2024, to address waste segregation and disposal at the panchayat level.
2. **Waste Crisis:** HP faces a severe waste management crisis, with ineffective execution of past plans worsening the situation.
3. **Daily Waste Generation:** The state generates around 375 tonnes of solid waste daily across 60 urban local bodies (ULBs).
4. **Legacy Waste:** Over 2.48 lakh tonnes of legacy waste remain untreated, with only six of 16 identified sites cleared so far.
5. **Sewage Treatment Shortfall:** The National Green Tribunal highlighted a 9.6-MLD (million litres per day) shortfall in sewage treatment capacity.
6. **Lack of Sewage Facilities:** 20 ULBs still lack sewage management facilities, exacerbating the waste problem.
7. **Overloaded Treatment Plants:** Some sewage treatment plants are overloaded, while many households remain unconnected, revealing poor planning.
8. **Plastic Waste Management:** The government has partnered with cement manufacturers to co-process non-recyclable plastic waste, but this is a limited solution.
9. **Plastic Pollution:** A significant amount of plastic waste, including shampoo bottles and chips packets, continues to pollute water bodies and urban areas.
10. **Rural Waste Disposal:** Over four lakh rural households lack access to proper wet waste disposal systems.
11. **Need for Comprehensive Strategy:** Incremental measures are insufficient; a long-term, action-oriented strategy is required.
12. **Key Measures:** Mandatory waste segregation at source, expansion of waste-to-energy projects, stricter plastic regulations, and comprehensive recycling initiatives are essential.
13. **Environmental Cell:** The newly announced environmental cell within the Urban Development Department must address policy gaps effectively.
14. **Ecological Fragility:** HP's fragile ecology is at risk due to poor waste management practices.
15. **Voter Responsibility:** Voters must prioritize waste management as a poll issue to push the government toward outcome-driven enforcement and prevent environmental degradation.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



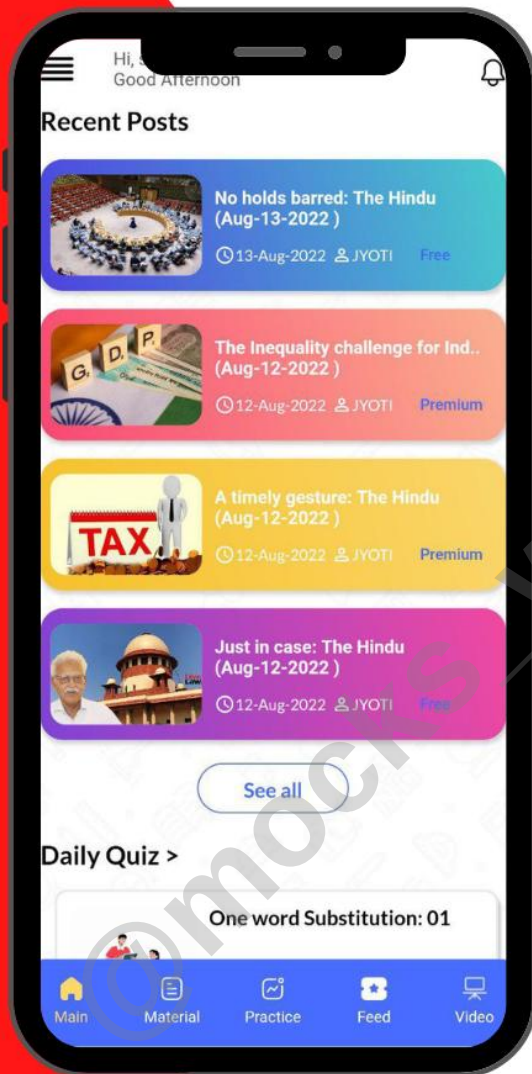
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